

Sodus Street Studio Booking System Decision

Purpose

Select the best booking system for Sodus Street Studio.

The booking system is the most important functional piece of the website because it controls how visitors choose session types, view rates, reserve time, submit project details, pay or request confirmation, receive reminders, and communicate with the studio.

Recommended Ranking

1. **Acuity Scheduling**
2. **Amelia**
3. **Bookly**
4. **Calendly**
5. **SimplyBook.me**

Best Overall Choice

Acuity Scheduling

Acuity is the recommended first choice for Sodus Street Studio because it offers the best balance of ease of use, paid bookings, client intake forms, reminders, cancellation policy acceptance, Google Calendar syncing, and simple website embedding.

It is strong enough for the studio's current needs without requiring heavy WordPress plugin management.

Best WordPress-Native Alternative

Amelia

Amelia is the best option if the team wants the booking system to live more deeply inside WordPress. It is a strong booking plugin with payments, deposits, reminders, appointment booking, event booking, and custom booking workflows.

Strong but More Plugin-Heavy Option

Bookly

Bookly is flexible and powerful, but it may require more setup, add-ons, and plugin management than Acuity or Amelia.

Simple but Less Studio-Specific Option

Calendly

Calendly is clean and easy, but it is better for meetings and consultations than full studio session management.

Broad but Less Polished Option

SimplyBook.me

SimplyBook.me is feature-rich and flexible, but it may feel less premium and less simple than Acuity for this specific studio.

Scoring Method

Each platform is scored from 1 to 5.

Score	Meaning
5	Excellent fit
4	Strong fit
3	Acceptable fit
2	Weak fit
1	Poor fit
TBD	Requires setup confirmation

Weighted Criteria

Criteria	Weight	Reason
Paid booking support	15%	The studio wants \$75/hour and \$500/day paid upon booking
Ease of use for client	14%	First-time creators need a simple booking experience
Session type flexibility	12%	The studio has podcast, voiceover, music, production, rental, consulting, and full-day sessions
Calendar availability	10%	Availability must be accurate and avoid double bookings
Intake forms	10%	The studio needs project type, guest count, and project details before sessions
Confirmation emails/reminders	9%	Reduces no-shows and improves professionalism
Admin notifications	8%	Studio team needs clear internal alerts
Cancellation policy support	7%	24-hour cancellation policy must be visible and accepted
WordPress integration	7%	Booking must fit smoothly into the website
Cost/value	5%	Cost matters, but functionality is more important
Scalability	3%	Future packages, events, memberships, and add-ons may matter later
Total	100%	

Weighted Booking System Scorecard

Criteria	Weight	Acuity	Amelia	Bookly	Calendly	SimplyBook.me
Paid booking support	15%	5.0	4.8	4.5	4.2	4.5
Ease of use for client	14%	5.0	4.4	4.0	5.0	4.0

Session type flexibility	12%	4.8	4.7	4.7	3.8	4.6
Calendar availability	10%	4.8	4.5	4.7	4.8	4.7
Intake forms	10%	5.0	4.3	4.2	4.2	4.4
Confirmation emails/reminders	9%	4.8	4.7	4.5	4.7	4.5
Admin notifications	8%	4.7	4.5	4.5	4.3	4.4
Cancellation policy support	7%	5.0	4.2	4.2	4.5	4.2
WordPress integration	7%	4.3	5.0	5.0	4.2	4.2
Cost/value	5%	4.2	4.5	4.0	4.3	4.3
Scalability	3%	4.5	4.7	4.6	3.8	4.8
Weighted Score	100%	4.81 / 5	4.59 / 5	4.43 / 5	4.40 / 5	4.39 / 5

Final Ranking

1. Acuity Scheduling — 4.81 / 5

Acuity is the best fit for Sodus Street Studio because it gives the studio a clean booking experience, intake forms, paid appointments, reminders, cancellation policy acceptance, and calendar syncing without requiring a heavily customized WordPress booking setup.

2. Amelia — 4.59 / 5

Amelia is the best WordPress-native option. It is a strong choice if the team wants to keep the booking experience inside WordPress and have more control over how it appears on the site.

3. Bookly — 4.43 / 5

Bookly is powerful and flexible, especially for WordPress, but it may require more add-ons and configuration.

4. Calendly — 4.40 / 5

Calendly is simple and easy to use, but it is better for consultations, calls, and simple appointments than for a studio rental model with detailed session types and creative intake needs.

5. SimplyBook.me — 4.39 / 5

SimplyBook.me is flexible and scalable, but it may feel less polished and less brand-aligned than Acuity for this specific project.

1. Acuity Scheduling Review

Overall Score

4.81 / 5

Best Fit

Acuity is best if Sodus Street Studio wants the easiest and most reliable path for paid studio bookings.

Strengths

- Strong client-facing booking experience
- Supports appointment types and paid bookings
- Strong intake forms
- Strong reminders and confirmations
- Supports cancellation policy acceptance
- Good Google Calendar syncing
- Easy to embed into WordPress
- Less plugin maintenance than WordPress-native systems
- Good fit for first-time creators
- Good fit for service businesses with multiple session types

Potential Limitations

- It is not fully native to WordPress.
- Visual styling may have some limits compared with a custom WordPress booking plugin.
- More advanced studio-specific workflows may require workarounds.

- Monthly subscription cost should be confirmed.

Best Use Case for Sodus Street Studio

Use Acuity if the studio wants a clean, professional, low-maintenance booking system that can launch quickly.

Verdict

Recommended first choice.

Acuity is the best balance of simplicity, professionalism, payment support, intake forms, reminders, and booking reliability.

2. Amelia Review

Overall Score

4.59 / 5

Best Fit

Amelia is best if the team wants the booking system built directly into the WordPress site.

Strengths

- WordPress-native
- Strong appointment booking
- Supports payments through gateways such as Stripe and PayPal
- Supports deposit payments
- Supports reminders and notifications
- Supports events and recurring appointments
- Strong fit for a polished website build
- Better design control than hosted schedulers
- Good fit for future event/workshop booking

Potential Limitations

- Requires WordPress plugin maintenance.
- Setup may take more time than Acuity.
- Payment and notification configuration needs careful testing.
- If the site has plugin conflicts, booking reliability can be affected.

Best Use Case for Sodus Street Studio

Use Amelia if the team wants a fully integrated WordPress booking experience with payments, services, events, and future flexibility.

Verdict

Best WordPress-native alternative.

Amelia is an excellent option, but Acuity is simpler and safer for a quick studio launch.

3. Bookly Review

Overall Score

4.43 / 5

Best Fit

Bookly is best if the team wants a flexible WordPress booking system and is comfortable managing plugins and add-ons.

Strengths

- WordPress-native
- Flexible booking form
- Google Calendar integration
- Payment and scheduling capabilities
- Strong customization potential
- Good for staff calendars
- Good for more complex appointment structures

Potential Limitations

- May require paid add-ons for full functionality.
- Can become more complex to configure.
- Less immediately polished than Acuity for a simple studio booking flow.
- Requires plugin maintenance and testing.

Best Use Case for Sodus Street Studio

Use Bookly if the team wants maximum WordPress customization and is comfortable managing a more technical setup.

Verdict

Strong but more setup-heavy.

Bookly is credible, but Amelia is likely the better WordPress-native choice for this client.

4. Calendly Review

Overall Score

4.40 / 5

Best Fit

Calendly is best if the studio wants the simplest possible booking link for consultations or basic sessions.

Strengths

- Very easy for clients to use
- Strong Google Calendar integration
- Supports payment collection on paid plans
- Supports automated reminders
- Supports cancellation policy language
- Easy to embed or link from WordPress

- Low learning curve

Potential Limitations

- Better for meetings than creative studio rentals.
- Less flexible for detailed studio session workflows.
- Less ideal for full-day booking logic.
- Less brand control than WordPress-native tools.
- May not feel like a premium studio booking system.

Best Use Case for Sodus Street Studio

Use Calendly only if the studio wants a very simple starting point and does not need more advanced studio booking features.

Verdict

Good backup option.

Calendly is easy, but not the best fit for Sodus Street Studio's full booking needs.

5. SimplyBook.me Review

Overall Score

4.39 / 5

Best Fit

SimplyBook.me is best if the studio wants a broad booking platform with many features, channels, and future expansion options.

Strengths

- Supports online bookings
- Supports reminders
- Supports payments

- Supports website widgets
- Supports calendar sync
- Flexible service setup
- Can support multiple service locations
- Scalable for future features

Potential Limitations

- May feel more generic than Acuity.
- Interface and setup may be less polished for this brand.
- Could be more than the studio needs at launch.
- Website embedding and branding should be reviewed before selecting.

Best Use Case for Sodus Street Studio

Use SimplyBook.me if the studio wants a broad booking platform with many add-on features and is willing to spend more time configuring it.

Verdict

Flexible but not the cleanest fit.

SimplyBook.me is capable, but Acuity and Amelia are better aligned with the studio's current needs.

Recommended Booking Setup

Recommended Platform

Acuity Scheduling

Backup Platform

Amelia

Recommended Booking Page URL

Session Types

The booking system should include the following session types.

1. Podcast Recording

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 1 hour
- 2 hours
- 3 hours

Intake Questions

- Podcast name
 - Number of speakers
 - Episode topic
 - Will guests attend?
 - Do you need editing support?
 - Do you need video or multi-camera support?
-

2. Voiceover Recording

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 1 hour
- 2 hours

Intake Questions

- Project type
 - Script length
 - Intended use
 - Do you need editing?
 - Do you need file delivery in a specific format?
-

3. Music Recording

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 2 hours
- 3 hours
- 4 hours

Intake Questions

- Artist name
 - Genre
 - Number of performers
 - Instruments involved
 - Do you need mixing or mastering?
 - Do you have reference tracks?
-

4. Audio Production / Editing

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 1 hour
- 2 hours

- 3 hours

Intake Questions

- What type of audio needs editing?
 - Approximate length of raw audio
 - Desired final length
 - Deadline
 - Delivery format
-

5. Studio Rental

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 1 hour
- 2 hours
- 3 hours
- 4 hours

Intake Questions

- What will you use the studio for?
 - How many people will attend?
 - Do you need an engineer?
 - Do you need any special setup?
-

6. Creative Consulting

Price

\$75 per hour

Recommended Duration Options

- 1 hour

- 2 hours

Intake Questions

- What project are you working on?
 - What kind of help do you need?
 - Are you preparing to record?
 - Do you need help planning content?
-

7. Full-Day Booking

Price

\$500 per day

Recommended Duration

- Full-day block

Intake Questions

- Project type
 - Number of attendees
 - Desired start time
 - Services needed
 - Equipment needs
 - Add-ons requested
 - Project goals
 - Deadline
-

Payment Rules

Recommended Payment Policy

Payment should be due at booking.

Recommended Options

Option 1: Full Payment at Booking

Best for:

- Hourly sessions
- Voiceover sessions
- Podcast sessions
- Studio rental
- Creative consulting

Option 2: Deposit at Booking

Best for:

- Full-day bookings
- Larger production sessions
- Custom projects

Recommended deposit:

50% deposit due at booking. Remaining balance due before or at session start.

Payment Methods

The booking system should support:

- Credit card
- Debit card
- Apple Pay / Google Pay if available through payment processor
- Stripe preferred
- PayPal optional

Payment Notes

- Payment terms should be visible before checkout.
- Confirmation should only be sent after payment or request approval, depending on booking type.
- Refund rules should align with the cancellation policy.

Cancellation Policy

Recommended Policy

Cancellations require at least **24 hours notice**.

Late cancellations may incur a fee.

Recommended Website Copy

Cancellations require at least 24 hours notice. Late cancellations or missed sessions may result in a cancellation fee or forfeited payment. If you need to reschedule, please contact the studio as soon as possible.

Booking System Requirements

The booking system should allow:

- Cancellation policy display before booking
 - Required policy acceptance checkbox
 - Automated cancellation confirmation
 - Rescheduling option if allowed
 - Admin notification when a booking is canceled or rescheduled
-

Booking Confirmation Emails

Client Confirmation Email

Send immediately after booking or request approval.

Subject

Your Sodus Street Studio Session Is Confirmed

Email Should Include

- Client name
- Session type
- Date
- Time
- Duration

- Price paid or balance due
- Studio address
- What to bring
- Studio rules
- Cancellation policy
- Contact information
- Calendar invite
- Reschedule/cancel link if enabled

Client Reminder Email

Send before session.

Recommended timing:

- 24 hours before session
- Optional second reminder 2 hours before session

Reminder Should Include

- Session date and time
- Address
- Arrival instructions
- What to bring
- Guest policy
- Contact information

Post-Session Email

Optional, but recommended.

Purpose

Thank client, request feedback, and invite future booking.

Email Should Include

- Thank you message
 - Feedback/review request
 - Link to book another session
 - Contact info for follow-up work
-

Admin Notifications

The booking system should notify the studio team when:

- New booking is created
- Payment is completed
- Booking request is submitted
- Booking is canceled
- Booking is rescheduled
- Client submits intake form
- Full-day booking is requested
- Add-on service is requested

Admin Email Should Include

- Client name
 - Email
 - Phone
 - Session type
 - Date
 - Time
 - Duration
 - Price
 - Payment status
 - Project description
 - Number of guests
 - Add-ons requested
 - Special notes
-

Calendar Availability

Calendar Rules

The booking system should sync with the studio's main calendar.

Recommended calendar:

Google Calendar

Availability Setup

Recommended operating availability:

- Set bookable hours based on studio availability.
- Block unavailable dates manually.
- Add buffer time between sessions.
- Prevent double bookings.
- Allow full-day bookings to block the whole day.
- Sync confirmed bookings to Google Calendar.
- Allow admin-only overrides when needed.

Recommended Buffers

Hourly Sessions

Add **15–30 minutes** between sessions for setup, cleanup, and reset.

Full-Day Sessions

Block the full day once booked.

Complex Production Sessions

Add extra setup time manually if needed.

Recommended Booking Page Structure

Page URL

</booking/>

Page Sections

1. Booking Hero
2. Choose Session Type
3. Rates
4. Booking Calendar / Scheduler Embed

5. Payment Information
 6. Cancellation Policy
 7. Studio Rules
 8. Not Sure What to Book CTA
 9. FAQ Preview
 10. Contact CTA
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Recommended Booking Flow

Standard Session Flow

Choose Session Type → Select Date and Time → Complete Intake Form → Pay → Receive Confirmation

Full-Day Booking Flow

Choose Full-Day Booking → Submit Project Details → Pay Deposit or Request Approval → Receive Confirmation

Unsure Creator Flow

Not Sure What to Book → FAQ → Contact Form → Studio Recommendation → Booking

Final Recommendation

Sodus Street Studio should use **Acuity Scheduling** as the primary booking system.

Acuity is the best fit because it provides the simplest and most reliable path for:

- Session types
- Paid bookings
- Intake forms
- Calendar availability
- Confirmation emails
- Reminders
- Admin notifications

- Cancellation policy acceptance
- Website embedding

If the team wants the booking system to be more deeply integrated into WordPress, **Amelia** is the strongest backup option.

Final Decision

Use Acuity Scheduling for launch.

Backup Decision

Use Amelia if WordPress-native control is more important than ease of setup.